SAIRA KALEEM

Information Security & GRC Professional | ISO 27001 | NIST CSF | SOC 2 | AWS Security Governance | IT Risk & Audit

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Information Security and GRC professional with 5+ years of experience across governance, risk management, compliance, cybersecurity, and cloud security. Hands-on experience includes enterprise and technology risk assessments, risk registers, internal audits, ITGCs, control design and testing, ISO 27001-aligned governance, Statements of Applicability, policy development, audit readiness, compliance monitoring, evidence management, findings management, corrective actions, and remediation tracking.

Experienced in developing integrated control frameworks and supporting governance activities across ISO/IEC 27001, 27017, 27018, 27701, 20000-1, and 42001, with a focus on improving control traceability and reducing duplicated compliance effort.

Earlier technical experience across AWS, Azure, GCP, DevSecOps, IAM, logging, monitoring, vulnerability management, and infrastructure security supports practical assessment of how security controls are implemented and evidenced. Currently developing GRC-as-Code and compliance automation approaches linking assets, risks, controls, evidence, assessments, findings, and remediation.

CORE COMPETENCIES

GRC & Assurance: Governance, Risk & Compliance (GRC) | IT Risk Management | Risk Assessments | Risk Registers | Internal Audit Support | ITGCs | Control Testing | Audit Readiness | Security Assurance | Corrective Actions | Remediation Tracking

Security Governance: Information Security Governance | Security Policy Development | Statement of Applicability (SoA) | Control Mapping | Evidence Management | Compliance Monitoring | Business Continuity & Disaster Recovery Concepts | Security Awareness

Cloud & Technical Security: AWS Security Governance | IAM | CloudTrail | CloudWatch | AWS Config | Security Hub | EKS | Logging & Monitoring | Vulnerability Management | Cloud Asset Inventory | Linux | DevSecOps

Automation & Delivery: GRC-as-Code | Compliance Automation | GitHub | Cross-functional Stakeholder Management | Executive Reporting | Technical-to-Business Risk Communication

FRAMEWORKS & STANDARDS

Applied / Current Work: ISO/IEC 27001, ISO/IEC 27017, ISO/IEC 27018, ISO/IEC 27701, ISO/IEC 20000-1, ISO/IEC 42001

Working Knowledge / Framework Exposure: ISO/IEC 27002, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF) 2.0, NIST SP 800-53, CIS Controls v8, SOC 2 Trust Services Criteria, COBIT 2019, PCI DSS 4.0, ISO 22301, ISO 31000, CSA Cloud Controls Matrix (CCM), GDPR concepts

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Al Nafi International College

GRC Lead | 2023 - Present

- Coordinate enterprise GRC activities across risk registers, security policies, Statements of Applicability, audit records, findings, corrective actions and remediation tracking.
- Develop a unified control framework spanning 6 ISO standards - ISO/IEC 27001, 27017, 27018, 27701, 20000-1 and 42001 - to consolidate overlapping control and evidence requirements into a single governance model.
- Establish AWS security governance covering cloud asset inventory and ownership, IAM, logging, configuration monitoring, security findings and audit evidence; coordinate implementation and remediation with DevOps, SysOps, AIOps and DataOps teams.
- Support internal audits, control design and operating-effectiveness reviews across access management, change management, logging, incident management and cloud-security controls; validate evidence and track findings through closure.
- Design a GRC-as-Code model linking frameworks, assets, risks, controls, evidence, assessments, findings, remediation actions and control owners to improve end-to-end traceability and support evidence automation.
- Define AI-governance requirements and AI-system inventory concepts aligned with ISO/IEC 42001, including ownership, risk, control and evidence considerations.

Assistant Manager - Cloud & Security Infrastructure | 2022 - 2023

- Managed and supported security-focused infrastructure across AWS, Microsoft Azure and Google Cloud Platform, including cloud migration, networking, monitoring, availability and infrastructure operations.
- Worked with technical teams on IAM and access controls, logging and observability, cloud security configuration, network connectivity, system availability, troubleshooting and operational security controls.

DevSecOps Engineer & Cyber R&D Analyst / Cyber Security Analyst | 2021 - 2022

- Built hands-on experience across cloud security, Linux, IAM, CI/CD, monitoring, security operations and DevSecOps workflows, creating the technical foundation now applied to GRC, IT risk and control assessments.

SELECTED GRC & CLOUD SECURITY PROJECT

GRC-as-Code & AWS ISO 27001 Audit Readiness Portfolio | Independent Portfolio Project

- Built a sanitized portfolio environment demonstrating risk registers, control mapping, evidence requirements, findings, remediation and ISO 27001 audit-readiness workflows without exposing employer information.
- Created machine-readable control definitions and validation logic to demonstrate control ownership, applicability, framework mapping and evidence requirements as code.
- Designed a GRC Command Center prototype linking applications, risks, controls, evidence, assessments, findings and remediation, with a roadmap for automated AWS evidence collection from IAM, CloudTrail, Config, Security Hub and related services.

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity (CC) | 2025
- EduQual Level 6 Diploma in AIOps | 2026
- Preparing for ISACA CISA examination | Target: November 2026
- Preparing for ISC2 CISSP examination | Target: January 2027

EDUCATION

- BS Computer Science | Virtual University of Pakistan